

- If you absolutely have to cover those greys, go for color instead of highlights. It's usually a little bit cheaper.
- If you do get highlights, opt for half a head instead of a whole. This stretches your money further and creates a much more natural effect.
- Get a cut/style that you don't have to trim every four to six weeks so you can go longer in between visits.
- Arrive with your hair already washed, or leave before the blow-dry. This shortens the service time and cost.
- Don't be coerced into deep conditioning treatments or add-on products. Prices are marked up and you can easily do the same thing at home.

If you don't have a stylist you're thrilled with, ask for recommendations from friends whose hair you *do* like, and see if the salon has any discounts for new customers. The majority also have referral programs so you can earn a free or discounted haircut just for telling your friends.

2. LEARN TO CUT HAIR

It took about seven years, but I finally convinced Joseph to let me cut his hair. He is pretty particular about getting a good cut, and even though it would save us about \$16 every few weeks, he still insisted on going to a barber. Well, no more. Now he claims that I can give him a better-looking cut than the stylist ever did!

If you want significant savings and also have a few boys in the house who don't mind your practicing on them, learn to cut their hair. You'll need a nice pair of hair scissors and a set of clippers for a more professional cut, but once you invest in those tools, you'll get years of use out of them. You can also give your own bangs a trim instead of stopping by the salon for a five-minute snip.

I recommend watching a few YouTube tutorials first, based on the type of cut you want to do. I found this extremely helpful in knowing exactly where